

2026 MAYFLOWER COMPACT QUARTER

Phantom of LaRose

Provisional die-marker and progression record for expert examination

Prepared from ten supplied microscope images and the collector's public "Death of a Die" documentation.



EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

The record shows a coherent group of small, location-specific features near the clasped hands. The images are sufficient to request an expert opinion. They are **not yet sufficient to claim a recognized variety**: the mint, specimen count, full-coin views, and repeatability across separate coins have not been documented in the supplied files.

CURRENT STRENGTHS

- Named diagnostic locations
- Annotated and unannotated close-ups
- Four timestamped contextual views
- Public progression narrative

HIGHEST-VALUE NEXT STEP

Photograph one candidate coin front and back, record its mint and acquisition source, then show the same three markers on a second coin if available.

SPECIMEN RECORD

The host coin is identified; the individual specimen is not

The United States Mint identifies this one-year design as the 2026 Mayflower Compact quarter. Its obverse shows two Pilgrims embracing; its reverse shows the *Mayflower* under full sail. The current photographs concentrate on the clasped-hands area and do not preserve the full identity of any single coin.

DENOMINATION Quarter dollar (25 cents)	PROGRAM 2026 Semiquincentennial
DESIGN Mayflower Compact	MINT Not recorded in supplied files
SPECIMEN COUNT Not established	ACQUISITION SOURCE Not recorded
WEIGHT / DIAMETER Not recorded	ORIENTATION Clasped-hands region documented

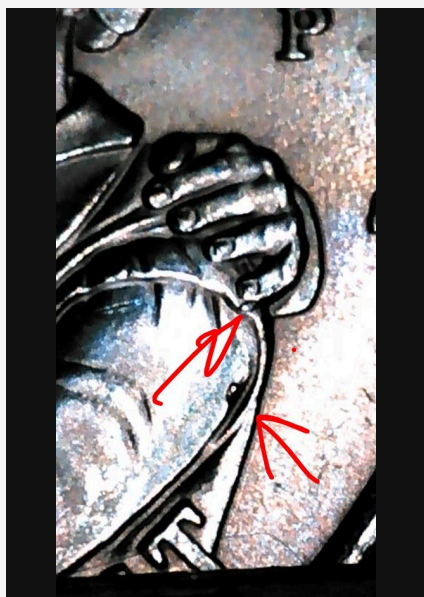
Do not submit this as a confirmed new variety. Submit it as a request to determine whether the marks represent a repeatable die variety, ordinary die deterioration, strike doubling, contact damage, or another cause.

MINIMUM IDENTITY RECORD TO ADD

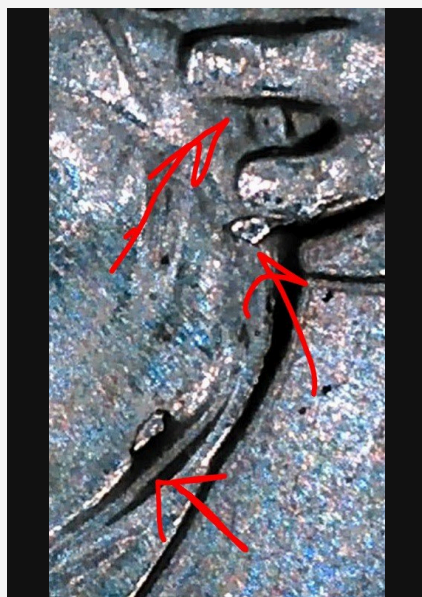
- Uncropped obverse photograph
- Uncropped reverse photograph
- Edge photograph
- Mint identification
- Weight to 0.01 gram
- Diameter to 0.1 millimeter
- Date and place found
- One specimen number per coin
- Same lighting for comparisons
- Images before annotation

Naming note: This package preserves the collector's labels exactly as pictured: "Mosquito Bite," "Splenter," and "Ant Bite." "Splenter" should be confirmed before public submission if "Splinter" was intended.

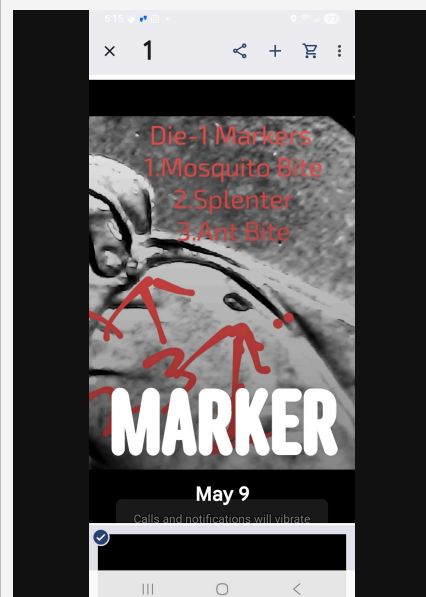
Three features near the hands form the working marker set



View A. Two red arrows indicate features along and below the hand.



View B. Three arrows isolate line-like or raised-looking features.



Reference label. The supplied image names the three “Die-1 Markers.”

MOSQUITO BITE

Collector label for a small localized point feature. Exact relief and coordinates need an unannotated macro image.

SPLENTER

Collector label for a thin line or chip-like feature. Spelling and morphology should be confirmed.

ANT BITE

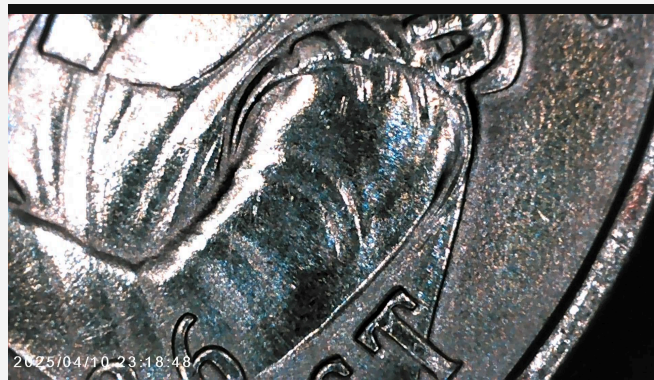
Collector label for another small point feature. Incuse versus raised relief is not resolved here.

Key diagnostic test: a true die marker should recur in the same location, shape, and orientation on more than one coin struck from the same die.

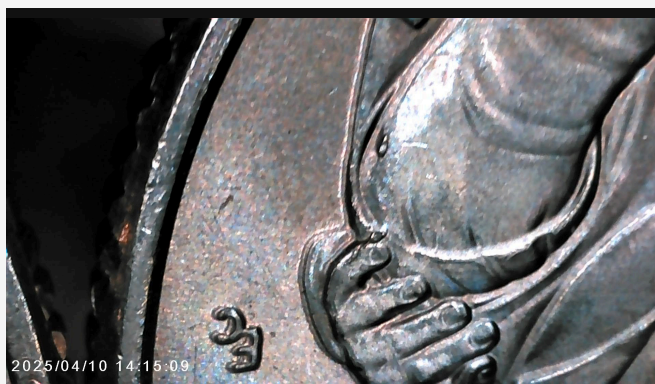
Timestamped wide views preserve orientation around the design



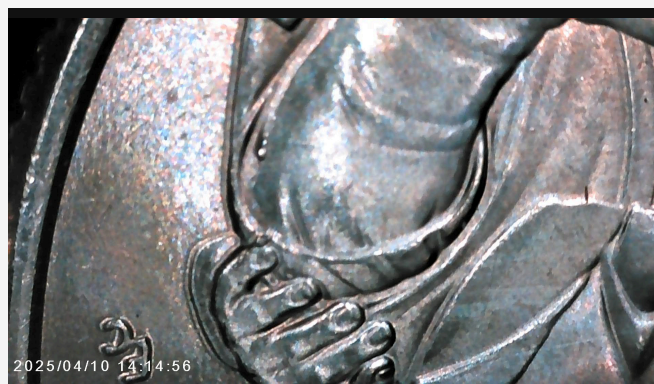
Context 01 - 23:18:51. Hands, surrounding field, and nearby inscription detail.



Context 02 - 23:18:48. Adjacent arm and field at a similar scale.



Context 03 - 14:15:09. Second hand area and nearby inscription detail.



Context 04 - 14:14:56. Companion view taken thirteen seconds earlier.

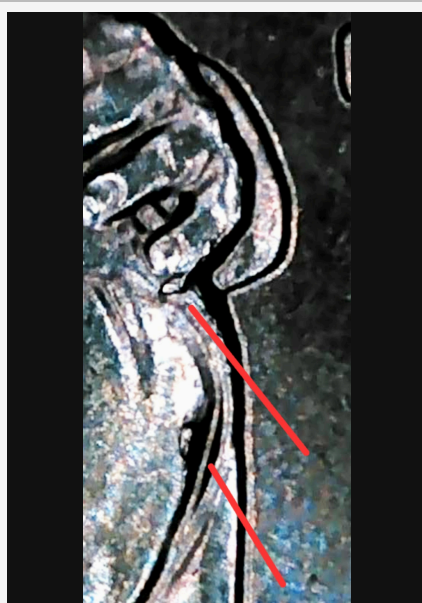
Chronology caution: these images display “2025/04/10,” which predates the 2026 coin date. That may reflect an incorrect microscope clock. Confirm the true capture date before using the timestamp as evidence of progression.

For formal comparison, add a small locator box on a full-coin image showing exactly where each context frame sits. Keep the original files unchanged and create separate annotated copies.

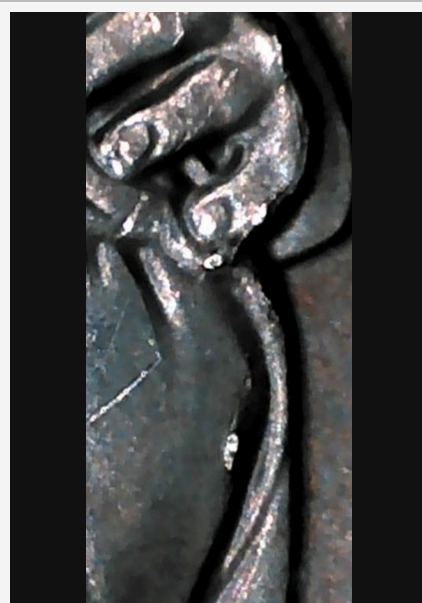
Line-like and dot-like features deserve separate testing



Multi-feature map. Useful as a locator, but dense annotation obscures some surfaces.



Possible doubling. The image marks a separation along a design edge; cause is unconfirmed.



Point features. An unannotated view preserves surface texture and lighting response.

WORKING HYPOTHESES TO TEST

DIE-ORIGIN POSSIBILITIES

- Small die chip or break
- Die crack or retained fragment
- Die clash transfer
- Progressive die deterioration

NON-VARIETY POSSIBILITIES

- Contact or circulation damage
- Lighting or focus artifact
- Machine/strike doubling
- Plating or surface disturbance

Relief direction matters. Tilt lighting from four directions and record whether each feature remains visibly raised or incuse. Do not sharpen or enhance the submission images beyond basic exposure and white-balance correction.

The evidence supports examination, not market claims

Best current conclusion: this is a documented candidate die-marker group with a plausible progression story. Independent attribution has not been established.

REASONABLE STATEMENTS NOW

- The photographs show multiple small features clustered near a consistent design area.
- The collector has assigned provisional names to three markers and assembled comparative views.
- A public “Death of a Die” reel records a broader progression narrative, including the “Scare Face” label.
- An expert can use this package to request better evidence or a physical examination.

STATEMENTS TO AVOID UNTIL CONFIRMED

- “New recognized variety,” “unique,” “rare,” or a dollar-value claim.
- Calling every line a doubled die, clash, crack, or break without diagnostics.
- Claiming chronological progression from camera timestamps that may be incorrect.
- Assuming multiple photographs represent multiple coins.

Market reality: third-party grading services may decline to attribute insignificant chips, breaks, cracks, normal die wear, strike doubling, or die deterioration. Recognition depends on the feature class, repeatability, significance, and the catalog's policies.

A strong negative opinion is still useful: it clarifies the correct classification and prevents unsupported sales claims.

SUBMISSION PLAN

Seven steps turn the archive into an attribution request

- 1 Assign specimen IDs.** Label each physical coin PL-01, PL-02, and so on. Never mix photographs from different coins without saying so.
- 2 Photograph the whole coin.** Capture obverse, reverse, and edge before macro work. Include a ruler or scale image separately.
- 3 Re-shoot the markers.** Make one unannotated image and one annotated copy for each marker. Keep magnification and lighting consistent.
- 4 Prove repeatability.** Show the same marker configuration on at least two independently found coins if available.
- 5 Build a chronology.** Record acquisition and photography dates outside the image. Treat embedded microscope dates as unverified until checked.
- 6 Post to the CONECA forum.** Create an account, open a new-attribution thread, and attach the concise evidence set. Do not mail a coin until an assigned attributor provides instructions.
- 7 Publish carefully.** Share the process and ask for comparison specimens. Describe the name as provisional until an attribution number is issued.

CONECA process: membership is not required, but a forum ID is. The public service page lists attribution at \$8 per coin for members and \$10 for non-members, plus return postage and insurance. Confirm current fees before sending.

DRAFT FORUM SUBJECT

2026 Mayflower Compact quarter - request for review of repeatable clasped-hands markers ("Phantom of LaRose," provisional)

A concise request keeps the examiner focused on the evidence

Hello,

I am requesting an expert opinion on a possible die-marker group on a 2026 Mayflower Compact quarter. My provisional project name is "Phantom of LaRose." The three working marker labels are "Mosquito Bite," "Splenter," and "Ant Bite," all located near the clasped-hands design area.

I have attached full-coin photographs, unannotated macro photographs, annotated locator copies, and comparison images. I am asking whether these features are consistent with a repeatable die variety, ordinary die deterioration, strike doubling, post-mint damage, or another cause.

I am not representing this as an attributed variety. If a physical examination is needed, please provide the correct shipping instructions and current fee.

Thank you for your review.

Name

Forum username

Email or preferred contact

Date

ATTACH ONLY THE STRONGEST EVIDENCE

- Full obverse and reverse
- Three unannotated macros
- Three annotated copies
- Two-coin comparison, if available
- Specimen data sheet
- This concise cover note

Before posting: replace every missing specimen field. The current packet intentionally leaves unknowns unresolved rather than guessing.

The evidence index preserves the supplied record

No.	File	Role in package
01	2026-09-13 ... 001	Annotated hand close-up
02	2026-09-13 ... 002	Annotated line/chip close-up
03	2026-09-13 ... 003	Multi-marker map
04	2026-09-13 ... 004	Marker-name reference
05	2026-09-13 ... 005	Possible doubling lines
06	2026-09-13 ... 006	Unannotated point features
07	2025-04-10 ... 007	Wide view, 23:18:51
08	2025-04-10 ... 008	Wide view, 23:18:48
09	2025-04-10 ... 009	Wide view, 14:15:09
10	2025-04-10 ... 010	Wide view, 14:14:56

PUBLIC SOURCES

1. **United States Mint.** 2026 Semiquincentennial Rolls and Bags - Mayflower Compact. usmint.gov/.../MASTER_SEMIQMC.html
2. **CONECA.** Attribution Services. Forum-first submission process, fees, and assignment procedure. conecaonline.org/attribution-services/
3. **NGC / Mint Error News archive.** Public description of categories commonly excluded from variety attribution. minterrornews.com/features-11-8-10-variety_vs_mint_error.html
4. **Collector's Facebook reel.** "Death of a Die" / "Phantom of Larose" progression record, posted May 18, 2026. facebook.com/reel/1663173261566217/

Evidence status: The ten images in this packet are the complete photographic set currently on file. No physical coin examination, scale calibration, metadata verification, or independent attribution was performed.